



Glest: Opposing factions summon dragons and golems to battle. Screenshot from the Glest website.

powers. Note that other colonial powers are more likely than the tribes to violate treaties with you.

In FreeCol, your ethics will be tested through your choices. Do you coexist with the tribes, or wage war against them? Do you extract tribute from them because you are more powerful? Do you respect their rights to their country, or run them off it? Trading with the tribes pays dividends in FreeCol. The tribes pay well for your goods, and no taxes go to the crown, which is raising an army against you.

FreeCol isn't about mindless mayhem. Unlike most strategy games, FreeCol has the objective of winning independence from a colonial ruler. To do so, form an army and navy, and win the citizens' support by establishing a rebel government. And while you're at it, start newspapers and printing presses to stoke a pro-freedom feeling among your people!

FreeCol's charm is in its fantastic possibilities of alternate history. The emotions it inspires, though, feel real.

Urban governance in non-violent Lincity

Technically, Lincity is not a game, but a simulation. But it's a welcome breather after the slash-and-burn of the previous games, and it involves strategy. We've become a mature civilisation; now let's make the city sustainable in Lincity. The game offers no opportunity to wage wars, since there is no military. Our foes are underdevelopment, unemployment and pollution.

Lincity is not as complicated as it looks. That is because it deals with urban concerns. Start with a blank board, with a single village or with an existing city with problems. Lincity offers you not only 3D graphics, but also sound effects that will evoke the hustle and bustle of industry, transport and city living. Your micro- and macro-management skills are tested in this real-time game. Ensure that your residential sectors are close to markets/job centres, healthcare facilities, education and civic amenities. Keep your polluting manufacturing sectors at arm's length from residences. Match infrastructure development to income to keep the economy in the black. When you can, build a port and start exporting. Get cracking on your civic services,



Lincity: Mines, a pottery workshop, a market and two residential buildings in a basic village.

as your city progresses from the pottery age to the space age.

There are two ways to 'win' Lincity: crafting a sustainable economy, or building a spaceship and settling another planet. With no wars or violence, Lincity charms you with its 3D cartoon-style evocation of the sights and sounds of that complex organism, the city.

Installation instructions

All these games are accessible by default through the software manager on your system. It's straightforward to install the first three games. In your software manager, search for their names. In the case of Lincity, though, don't install the package called *lincity*; install *lincity-ng* instead, and you'll get the 3D graphics as promised. Note that these games are big downloads: Glest is about 55 MB, FreeCiv about 30 MB, FreeCol about 44 MB and Lincity about 51 MB.

Another thing: if Lincity is crashing, it's probably due to a bug in the graphics driver on your system. Try updating to the latest driver or (shudder!) install the proprietary driver. Then donate a bit of green to the free software driver developers.

Enjoy!

While it's a known fact that gaming choices on GNU/Linux are fewer than on Windows, how many games do you really need in order to have a great time? Fifty? You'll find more than that on GNU/Linux. For a comprehensive list of games, refer to websites like linuxgames.com, tuxgames.com and happypenguin.org. (For more juicy game reviews, stay tuned to this magazine.)

Technical note: To cure FreeCiv addiction—use the following command:

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sudo apt-get install willpower
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By: Suhit Kelkar

Write to this freelance journalist and photographer at suhitkelkar@gmail.com.